

watching for several minutes, fascinated by this eccentric fusion of man and machine—all the global electronics of computers, televisions, and telephones plugged into this anachronistic street-corner bazaar where the lone specialist presides, gesturing with his fingers, scribbling the results of his commerce on tiny slips of paper, not unlike the ancient merchants of Alexandria or Khar-toum.

“It’s a garage sale,” I exclaimed to Mr. Schwartz. Mr. Schwartz looked around and shook his head. “All bullshit and garbage,” he said. Something he saw on the trading floor reminded him that he’s being taken over by the Japanese. “You know,” he said, “in my house the only thing American is the kitchen table. Everything else is from Japan, Singapore, Korea. The Japanese, they don’t even have a word for *vacation* in their language. The Japanese haven’t had a vacation since Japan was started. When they need a rest, they go up into the mountains and sit in cubicles and put electrodes on their heads to think up new ideas. No wonder we’re lagging behind.

“We’d better get our act together,” warned Mr. Schwartz, waving his arms like Moses to encompass the full length and breadth of the New York Stock Exchange. “This is all bullshit and garbage.” He walked down the ramp to the little Quotron machines where he rechecked the price of Brooklyn Union Gas, and that’s the last I ever saw of him.